

2025 Budget Hearings September 5th Segment #2

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MeWLFehTTWo
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Target Category	delaware_county

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Comprehensive Municipal Meeting Summary

Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer reconvened the municipal meeting following a lunch recess [00:00:15](#). The session primarily focused on budget deliberations, department requests, and capital improvement planning.
- **Attendance:** Specific roll call was not formally recorded in the transcript; however, active board participants and department heads included:
 - Presiding Officer / Council Leaders (referred to in-text as Matt, Ryan, Eugene, Jim, and Council President/Members)
 - County Commissioners (including Commissioner Sherry Rigan)
 - Department Heads and Elected Officials: Fred (Communications / 911), Emily (Courts), Rick (Clerk / Election Board), Brad (Treasurer), Jan (Recorder), and the Sheriff.
 - Administrative/Financial Staff: Angie (Engineer/Consultant representative), Elizabeth, and Nancy.

Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded in this segment of the transcript.

- **Approval of Minutes:** None recorded in this segment of the transcript.
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Substantive Business & Board Action

1. 00:00:15 Discussion on County Bridge Fund & Proposed Civil Engineer Position

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Sherry Rigan.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Commissioner Rigan proposed budgeting \$70,000 for a part-time civil engineer position to oversee deteriorating county infrastructure, specifically the 30 remaining temporary timber bridges (built in 1988 with porous black bar rebar past their 35-year life expectancy) and fleet/capital expenses. Discussion ensued regarding state reimbursement subsidies: the state reimburses counties \$40,000 annually for a full-time County Highway engineer, and counties can jointly share an engineer while both collecting the \$40,000 subsidy. Council members (Matt, Ryan, Eugene) expressed the need for a more concrete plan, exploring shared-service options with neighboring counties, and identifying funding streams (storm water, highway, drainage, EDIT funds).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** No formal vote taken; referred for further research and future appropriation consideration.

2. 02:00:00 Sheriff's Department Budget & Pension Contribution Review

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** The Sheriff & Financial Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed the Sheriff's Department budget, operating supplies, uniforms/vests, and the accelerated 10-year pension funding plan. The council discussed reducing the pension request from the high-end estimate to the mid-range estimate of \$1,473,000, adjusting the sheriff's budget downward by \$473,447, and targeting a \$1 million reduction out of the LIT Public Safety fund.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Consensus reached to adjust pension and budget figures accordingly by voice consensus.
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Departmental Budget Reviews & Adjustments (Chronological Order)

3. 00:33:48 County General & Court Office Budgets (Page 1<U+2013>2)

- **Deliberation Summary:** The council reviewed overall county general operating balances, establishing a targeted cash reserve range of no less than \$6 million and no more than \$6.5 million. Emily presented the court office budgets, agreeing to spread computer equipment replacements across a 4-year cycle rather than bulk-purchasing.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Equipment line items adjusted (e.g., Court 40 equipment line 536 reduced to \$4,660) by consensus.

4. 00:43:45 Communications / 911 Budget (Page 65)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred (Communications Director).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed 911 dispatcher salaries, supervisor pay parity with the 901 fund, health insurance estimates (pegged at a worst-case 10% increase over new hires), and uniform line item adjustments. Fred noted a preference to prioritize staff salary adjustments over new positions if cuts are required. Line 221 (Operating Supplies) was reduced by \$1,000 to \$6,000.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Reductions accepted by voice consensus.

5. 01:06:08 Clerk Office & Election Board Budget (Page 5 & 20)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick (Clerk).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed deputy clerk salary leveling, part-time usage, and a major initiative to conduct voter list maintenance in non-election years. Rick noted that office supplies would temporarily increase to fund new filing boxes and system organization under one roof at the Justice Center.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Reviewed and accepted into budget tracking by consensus.

6. 01:37:47 Treasurer's Budget

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad (Treasurer).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed \$25,000 allocated for tax sale attorney fees, bank fees (\$10,000), part-time seasonal staffing (\$12/hr base with a 50-cent raise), and computer replacement rotations. The council debated whether the tax sale attorney fee line should reside in the Commissioners' budget or the Treasurer's budget.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Maintained as presented pending final fund balancing.

7. 01:51:48 Recorder's Budget (Page 8)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jan (Recorder).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Brief review of the recorder's perpetuation fund and staff allocations. Deputy positions supported via perpetuation funds.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

8. 02:26:42 Jail Budget & LIT Public Safety Adjustments (Page 21 & 52)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff & Nancy (Staff).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed jail operating costs, food, medical contract increases (line 311), part-time transport officer funding, and inmate uniforms vs. cleaning supplies. Corrections were made to LIT Public Safety FICA and PERF line items on Page 52, offset by reducing contractual services, holiday pay, overtime, and health insurance by \$12,705.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Technical corrections and budget adjustments approved by Voice Vote.
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Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *Note: No formal open public forum or citizen comment period involving members of the general public occurred during this session; proceedings were strictly confined to board members, elected officials, and department heads.*
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Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** The board agreed to conclude the day's budget work session at 5:00 PM to accommodate evening schedules and individual database reviews.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially recessed at **02:36:05**, with instructions to reconvene the budget work session the following morning at 8:30 AM.
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